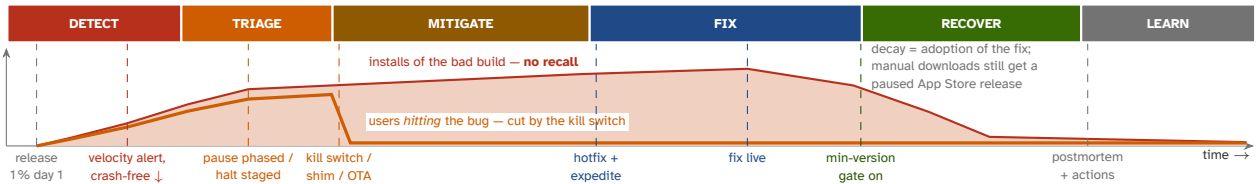


In one line: A build already on users' phones cannot be recalled — pausing or halting a rollout only stops it reaching *more* people. So: **detect** per version, **stop the spread** (pause / halt), **neutralise the bad path server-side** (kill switch, compatibility shim, OTA JS rollback), **ship a fix** (hotfix + expedited review, then force-update), **communicate**, and learn in a **blameless postmortem**.



Detect — per version, fastest first

signal	basis	what it says
Crashlytics velocity	30 min, one version	one crash/ANR type hits a set % of users — not sent until you pick a channel (regressed + trending: on by default)
crash-free users	a period	1 — crashed / all users, aggregated, not averaged; sessions beside it
Play vitals	28-day avg, daily	user-perceived crash 1.09 % , ANR 0.47 % , 8 % on one phone model; over → Play may cut visibility, warn on the listing
Xcode Crashes organizer	opt-in users	TestFlight: all users; no watchdog, jetsam, thermal or code-signature kills
MetricKit	on device	diagnostics delivered immediately (iOS 15+); iOS 27: MetricManager
backend · business	live	4xx/5xx, latency, payments by an App-Version header · funnel, logins; reviews and tickets lag

Units differ: vitals count per daily active user, Crashlytics per session — 1 crash in a user's 3 sessions = **100 %** vs **33 %**.

Declare, organise, triage

- **Declare** if any holds: a second team is needed · customers can see it · unsolved after an hour of concentrated analysis. Declaring early and closing on a simple fix beats starting hours in.
- **Stop the bleeding first** — make the system work as well as it can; root cause later.

role	holds
IC	the state and every role not delegated; the living incident document ; explicit handoff
Ops	the <i>only</i> hands changing the system — flags, rollout, backend
Comms	the public face: periodic updates to team + stakeholders (status page, in-app banner)
Planning	bugs, handoffs, every divergence (flag, shim) so it can be reverted

1. **Blast radius:** version/build, OS, device, region, locale, flag arm; % of DAU.
2. **What changed:** release, config/flag, backend deploy, OS release — line up the timelines.
3. **Harm:** data, money, security/privacy — or annoyance? **Workaround?**

sev	scale (PagerDuty)	mobile example
SEV-1	critical, many customers, or customer data exposed; public notice	launch crash for most; payments down
SEV-2	many customers cannot use the product	core flow broken
SEV-3	partial loss, not most customers; may grow into SEV-2	one OS or locale broken
SEV-4	minor; product still usable	slow screen
SEV-5	cosmetic	typo

SEV-1/2 = major incident, IC paged. Unsure? Take the **higher**; argue in the postmortem.

Who each lever reaches

lever	has it	more	catch
pause phased	×	part	auto-updates only: manual downloads, new installs still get it
halt staged / 100 %	×	✓	Play serves the previous release instead
remove from sale	×	✓	App Store, whole app, ≤ 24 h
kill switch / flag	✓	✓	only if built in; at the next config fetch
backend shim	✓	✓	old response shape for build X; server debt
OTA rollback	✓	✓	JS only, same runtime version; next cold start
hotfix + force update	✓	✓	review + adoption; the gate must be in the old build

Stop the spread — the stores

	App Store — phased	Google Play — staged
pace	fixed 1-2-5-10-20-50-100 % over 7 days; random auto-update users	your %, never rises by itself; random new + existing users
for stop	version updates pause: 30 days in total, any number of times; resumes on the same day	updates, not the first publish halt: no additional users; resume to any %
leak at 100 %	anyone may download it manually submit an update, or remove the app	— halt it too: the previous full release is served to new users and all not on it — not a track's first release
has it	keeps it	keeps it

Fix — hotfix, review, adoption

- Smallest diff, cherry-picked to the release branch. App Store: incremental version + incremented build string; Play: versionCode above every previous one (max 2 100 000 000).
- **Review:** ≥ 50 % in < 24 h, 90 % in < 48 h. **Expedited:** only a submission already sent; critical bug + steps to reproduce on the current version in *Notes*; granted as availability allows. A rejected bug-fix with no legal/safety issue may ship, fixed next time — once per issue. Then phased, or **Release to All Users** at any time.
- **Force update:** min_supported in config → blocking screen → store. Play in-app updates: IMMEDIATE (full screen; Play installs + restarts) or FLEXIBLE (background); inAppUpdatePriority 0-5 set at rollout via the Play Developer API, never changed.
- **Recovered** = that version's crash-free / funnel back at *baseline*, not "PR merged".

Kill switch — config, timing, crash loops

```
{ "min_supported": { "ios": "4.12.1", "android": 41201 }, "kill": { "new_checkout": { "ios": ["4.13.0"] } }, "banner": { "text": "Payments delayed, fixing now" } }
```

- Firebase Remote Config: default minimum fetch interval **12 h**; values apply on activate. Real-time listener (Apple SDK 10.7.0+): server invalidation → fetch past the interval, foreground only.
- **expo-updates** guards JS crash loops: an error before the first render on an update's first launch marks it failed, waits 5 s for a newer one, else reloads the last that launched; > 10 s after first render it is not caught. eas update:rollback → a previous update or the embedded one.

Learn — blameless postmortem

- **Triggers:** user-visible degradation past a threshold · any data loss · on-call intervention · resolution time past a threshold · a monitoring failure · any stakeholder asks.
- **Record:** timeline (UTC; TTD, TTM, TTR), impact in numbers, actions, root cause(s), follow-ups with owner + date. **Blameless:** causes, not culprits — everyone acted in good faith on what they knew.

Traps

- ! Launch crash before config loads: no kill switch reaches it — guard crash loops, cache config.
- ! Removing from sale to stop a phased release: reinstated, the version goes to 100 % at once.

Remember

Stop the spread, kill the path, ship the fix, force the stragglers, write it down.